

Management Competencies in the Republic of Uzbekistan

Interest in “Digital” and Confident Growth

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and Confident Growth

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Welcome message



**Alexander
Kim**

Rector, Moscow School
of Management SKOLKOVO

The development of human resources is the foundation for sustainable economic growth and a country's competitiveness. It is those leaders, who are able to think strategically, act responsively, inspire others and shape the future of economy and society.

This research of management competencies in Uzbekistan is a significant step towards establishing a systemic approach for developing a new generation of leaders. It helps to see real business needs, define priorities and build a framework where management education becomes a strategic instrument for national development.

For Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO, participation in this project aligns with our mission: to bring together international experience and local values — empowering countries and organisations to unlock people's potential.

I am sure, that the findings will become the platform for new initiatives, programmes and solutions that help Uzbekistan become a regional hub for modern management education.

Welcome message



**Denis
Konanchuk**

Director, Corporate Education
Department, Moscow School
of Management SKOLKOVO

Dear colleagues,

The Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO is pleased to present the first study, dedicated to the development of management competencies in the Republic of Uzbekistan. This is an important moment for us. This study may become a launch-pad for aligning business agenda with the training and development of management staff in the country.

We observed business in a phase of growth and expansion — including into Central Asian markets. This defines the tasks faced by the leading companies of Uzbekistan: the larger the business, the more clearly the demand for strong personnel, digital-transformation support, establishment of sustainable operational processes, and use of the best management practices. The common steps for increasing the efficiency of the employees are gaining unique features in Uzbekistan, due to the trend of internal career-growth.

This requires defining advanced management competencies that are in demand across various sectors of the economy. The last point constituted the semantic core of our research.

As recommendations, the experts of the School of Management SKOLKOVO offered to create a national model of managerial and professional competencies, as well as a comprehensive system of educational courses designed to cultivate core leadership skills. From our point of view, building a strong network of business-education institutions strong support for Uzbekistan's economy would be the creation of a strong network of business-education institutions — business schools and corporate universities — as a unified system of talent pool for business. We believe that creating a strong network of business-education institutions — business schools and corporate universities, as a unified talent engine for business, would provide robust support for Uzbekistan's economy.

Moreover, an annual study of business competencies at the national level will allow to monitor the country's companies' needs in human resources and employee qualification.

While working on this research, we witnessed the professional engagement and committed approach of business leaders and entrepreneurs in Uzbekistan, interested in shaping joint learning processes and development of human resources within the country.



Welcome message



**Aziz
Gafurov**

Head of the Secretariat of the Council
of Foreign Investors under the President
of the Republic of Uzbekistan

Dear colleagues, business leaders and representatives!

Uzbekistan is now entering a phase of dynamic economic growth, accompanied by rapid digital-transformation and integration into the global economy. These processes impose new demands on the quality of management decisions and make the task of preparing highly qualified personnel particularly relevant.

The Foreign Investors Council under the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan, with the support of Council member Yandex Uzbekistan and in partnership with the Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO, initiated this study to assess the managerial and professional competency needs of national and international businesses operating in the Republic of Uzbekistan.

This research holds strategic importance for the country. Its goal is to develop a holistic picture of competencies that are in demand by business today, and management skills that are needed for development, and new approaches necessary for preparing new leaders and managers to implement the large-scale tasks within "Uzbekistan-2030" strategy.

The results of this research appear to us as fundamental for the processing of systematic decisions and programs aimed to develop leadership potential of the country, support business and create an environment suitable for investments.

We express our gratitude to all participants for their willingness to contribute to this initiative that carries a strategic significance for the future managerial and economic development of Uzbekistan.



Welcome message



**Sardor
Kadirov**

Vice President
for Strategic Development,
Yandex Uzbekistan

Today, digital transformation has become one of the key drivers of Uzbekistan's economic and social development. We are witnessing how technology is reshaping industries, transforming the labor market, and creating a new demand for managerial and entrepreneurial competencies.

Yandex Uzbekistan is actively contributing to these changes by expanding its presence and supporting the country's institutional development. For us, investment in Uzbekistan is not only about capital — it is about creating jobs, supporting small businesses, developing talent, and transferring technological solutions. In this context, we highly value the role of the Foreign Investors Council under the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan as an effective platform for dialogue and cooperation.

Digital technologies are, above all, about people — proactive, adaptable, and ready to lead. The presented research is an important contribution to understanding which skills and managerial qualities are essential for accelerating Uzbekistan's development. We are confident that its findings will serve as a foundation for joint efforts by the business community, government institutions, and academia to strengthen the country's human capital.



About the research

The "Management Competencies in the Republic of Uzbekistan" study was conducted by the Corporate Education Department of the Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO (SKOLKOVO ExEd), in partnership with the Foreign Investors Council under the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan and with the support of Yandex Uzbekistan, in September–October 2025. **A total of 176 respondents participated in the study.**



Research purpose

To create an analytical and methodological foundation for:

1

identifying the gap between the current management training system and business needs

Research methods



Online survey in Uzbek, Russian and English

2

systemic transformation of management education and formation of the state policy in the area of competencies

3

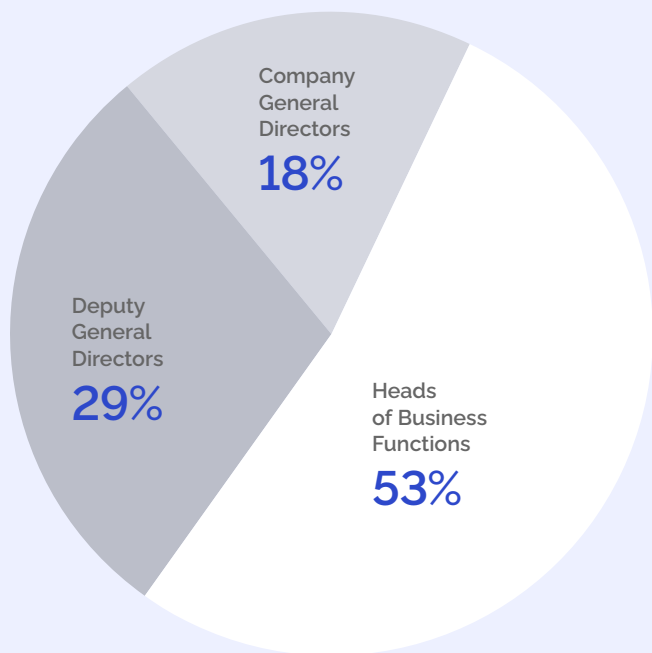
development of priorities and parameters of national human-capital-development programmes



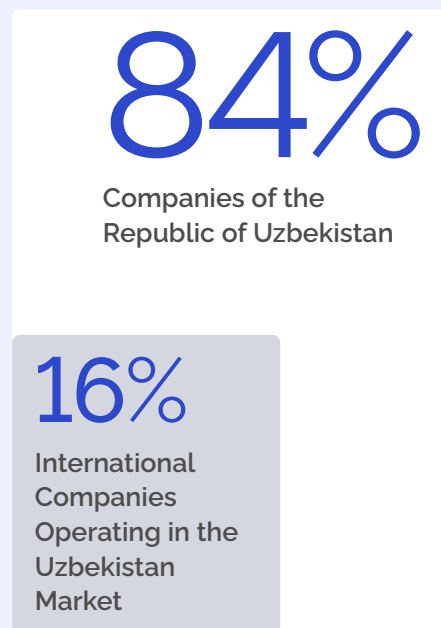
Semi-structured expert interviews

Target groups

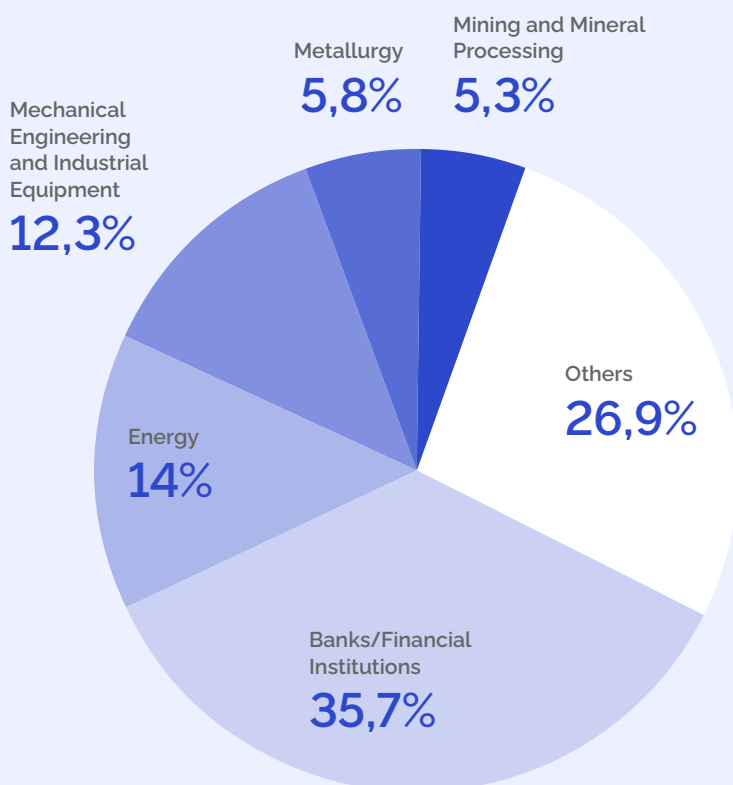
Participants profile



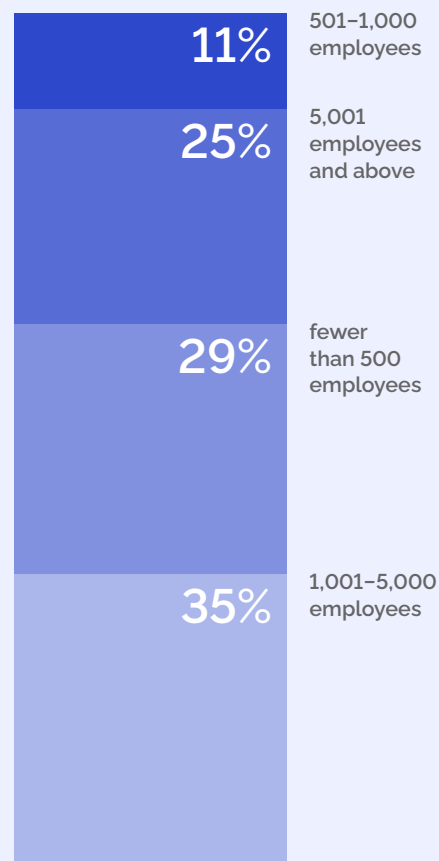
Companies profile



Industry Sector



Number of Employees in the Company



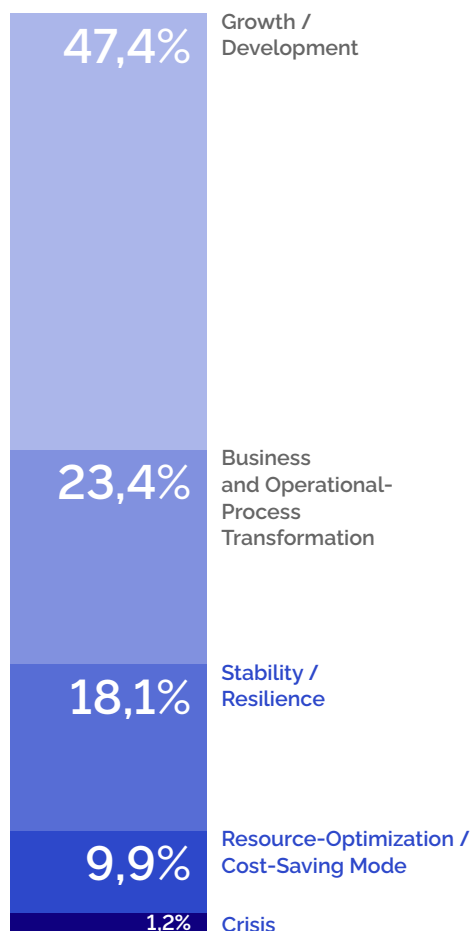
1

Growth & Demand for Talented Leadership: Business Priorities of Companies





Current Business Situation 2025



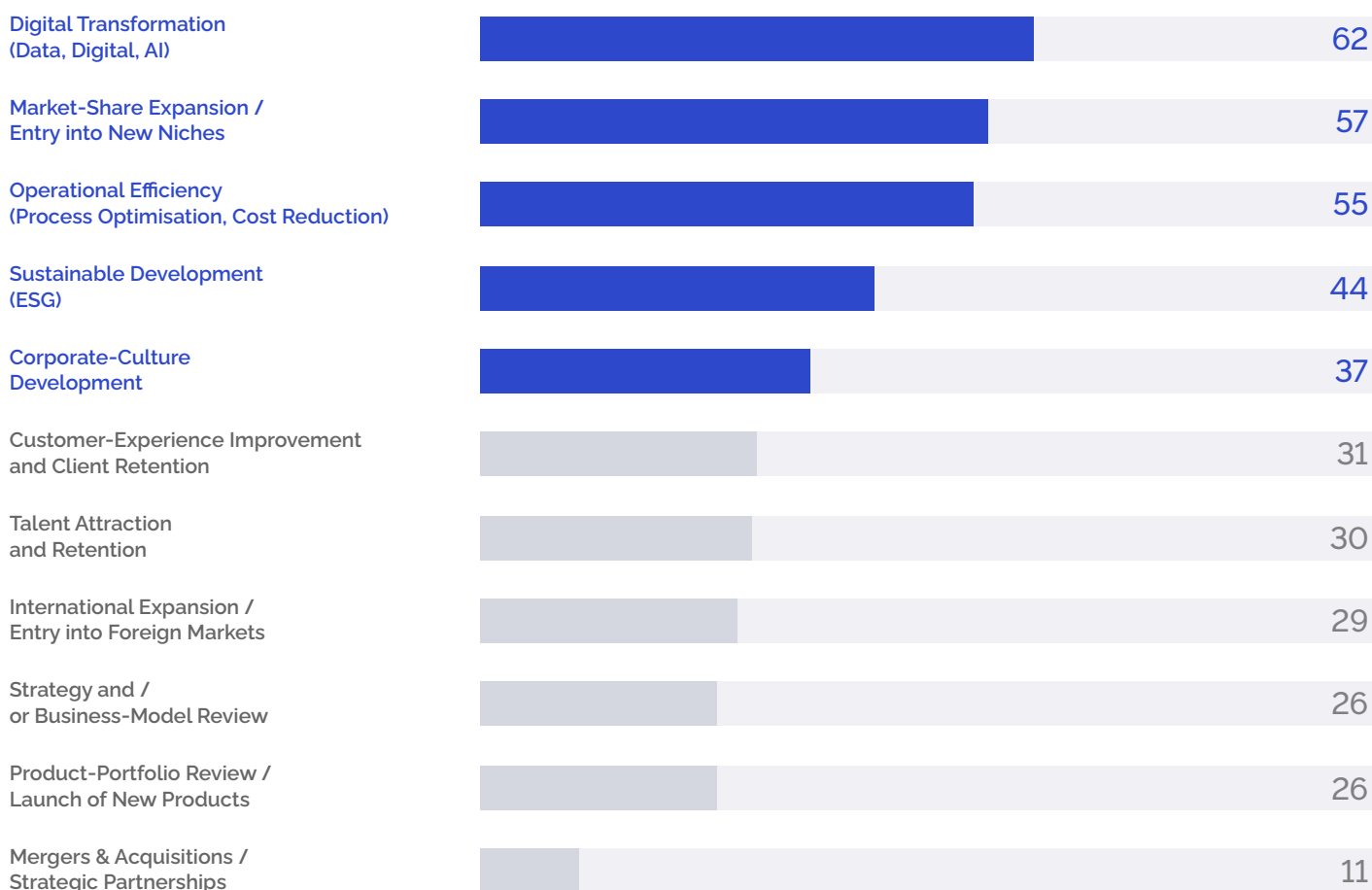
Nearly half of the participating companies (more than 47 %) are in a stage of growth and development; less than 2 % of large companies reported crisis signs. This outcome aligns with the forecasts of the World Bank and the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development, which indicate Uzbekistan's economy shows consistent year-on-year growth and remains among the fastest-growing in the region.

When comparing companies with more than 1 000 employees vs. less, large enterprises place somewhat higher emphasis on business and operational-process transformation (33.3% vs 29%). In expert commentary, business representatives noted that priorities are influenced by multiples in revenue growth, expansion into neighbouring Central Asian markets, and extension of product and solution portfolios.



Company Business Priorities Through 2027

%



From interviews with the research participants

«In the coming years the fight for talents, for their attention and retention will only intensify — not just in Uzbekistan, but perhaps in the CIS countries in general. There is a staff shortage which the education system does not always manage to solve — we see that the number of universities is growing faster than the quality of education. So far, we do not always receive from the 'output' personnel who meet our requirements, i.e., graduates are not always ready for the expectations we have».

— Head from the IT field

For the immediate future (through to 2027), company leaders prioritise: Digital transformation (62%), Market-share expansion and entry into new niches (57%), Operational efficiency (55%), Sustainable development / ESG (44%), Corporate-culture development (37%). The top-3 coincide for businesses of different scales. Interesting to note, despite equal interest, for example, in market-share expansion, companies of larger and smaller size show different interest in digital transformation and corporate-culture development. For large enterprises (over 1 000 employees) these areas are more relevant than for smaller ones.

In addition to the key business priorities, respondents spoke of considerable growth potential in improving the efficiency of external and internal processes, employees and teams in individual business areas. Speaking of corporate-culture development, they pointed out the need to combine the best international practices with the standards of doing business in Uzbekistan and the specific features of multinational teams.

Key HR Challenges

%



- Talent Outflow: high competition and rapid market growth make talent retention increasingly difficult
- Attraction, development and succession planning are becoming critical
- Overestimated competency expectations for graduates
- Shortage of local specialists
- (e.g., in renewable energy)
- Low consumer demand
- Uneven workload distribution among employees
- Outdated vocational-education system

From interviews with
the research participants

«There is a paradox that has arisen in recent years in Uzbekistan: on the one hand there are good specialists who are unemployed, and on the other — good companies that cannot find good specialists. Such a demand-and-supply imbalance is observed in certain areas. For example, we are an international company relying on technological-engineering solutions, and we see very few technical specialists on the market who can speak English. I explain this by objective reasons: until 2017 the country was literally closed for international business, i.e., the market in its current shape began to form less than 10 years ago. When an international company comes, its expectation that a local specialist will satisfy certain requirements which are natural for this company, but often are not met. This concerns both the job, internal procedures, subordination, and corporate culture».

— Head from the processing
& energy field

Among key human resource challenges: skills shortages (56%), low qualification of employees (50%) and high salary expectations (49%). If you analyze the situation by business size, you will find that the "problem №1" for companies is different. For large enterprises (more than 1 000 employees) the main challenge is low qualification, whereas companies of smaller scale suffer primarily from a general staff shortage.

Respondents talk about the universality of the staff deficit in Uzbekistan market: it concerns both experienced managers, who as a rule, already "found their place", and young specialists whose competency level does not fully meet company expectations. Separately, participants note the shortage of English-speaking specialists with engineering experience..

Experts opinion



Alexey Kalinin

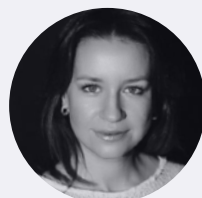
Professor of Business Practice, Academic Director of the Executive MBA programme, Vice-Rector for Research, Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO

Today Uzbekistan is, without exaggeration, experiencing the golden age of its economy. The country has entered a phase of rapid growth, ambitious reforms and openness to new opportunities. The economic boom we observe is the result of a combination of energetic state policy, growing investment and activeness of national business.

Uzbekistan is becoming one of the key economic centres of Central Asia, where new sectors are being formed, industrial potential is being strengthened and the entrepreneurial ecosystem is developing. These processes create a powerful demand for quality management education capable of providing the economy with competent leaders of the new generation.

The modern upturn of the country is inseparably linked with its cultural-historical roots. For centuries Uzbekistan was the heart of the Great Silk Road — a space where ideas, cultures and knowledge intersected. The tradition of learning, mentoring and knowledge exchange is deeply rooted in the national identity, and the aspiration for enlightenment and creation has always been part of the spirit of this land. Today, at a new turn of history, Uzbekistan returns to its origins, combining ancient culture of knowledge with the energy of innovation and modern entrepreneurship.

One can say that the country is entering a new era of leadership and creation, when the ambitions of the government and business coincide, and education once again becomes the very bridge that connects the past and the future.



Anna Semenova

Director of Corporate Clients Development, Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO

The business in Uzbekistan today feels like the energy of growth and ambition — the economy is in a phase of accelerated development. More and more companies see learning as a tool to maintain this pace, although the habit of system-learning still needs to be strengthened. Skills and tools are important, but even more important is to develop managerial thinking — the ability to reflect and apply them in real business situations.



Evgeny Plaksenkov

Professor, Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO

A notable feature of the research was the broad involvement of banks and other financial institutions in identifying the drivers of improvement and the most important directions of development of organisations and their human capital. Financial institutions are the life-support system of the whole economy. The disclosure of new opportunities of organisations in all activity spheres depends on them.

By combining efforts to implement priority goals with key personnel tasks companies can achieve higher results. To do this they will need to attract and develop new talents, form effective teams, ensure succession among key leaders. Training and development of leaders will play a key role in the success of all initiatives and projects.



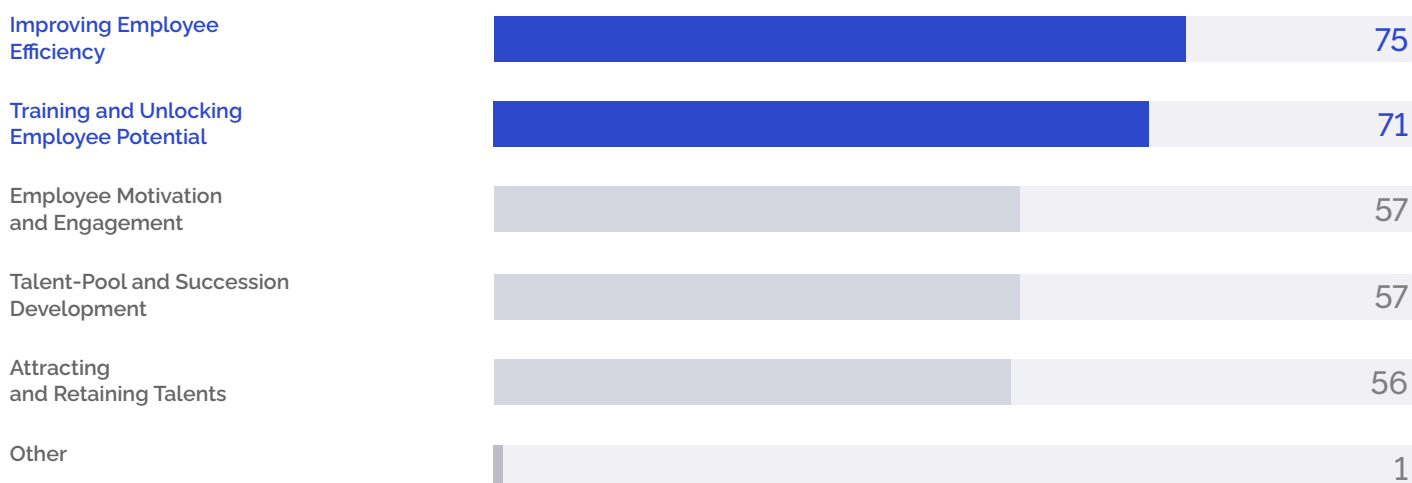
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The Deficit Depends on Scale: Personnel Related Tasks



Key HR Priorities Through 2027

%



Training employees in fundamental legal frameworks due to gaps in university education

From interviews with the research participants

When it comes to attracting and retaining valuable employees — based on my personal experience — I see that candidates who would be a perfect fit for us are not always satisfied with the conditions we offer. They often receive a more competitive offer elsewhere.

Therefore, we try to shape roles that appeal not only through financial compensation. We need to design and offer additional benefits, 'perks', but at the same time it is important for us to ensure that these employees continue to grow — because our expectations of them are also constantly increasing..

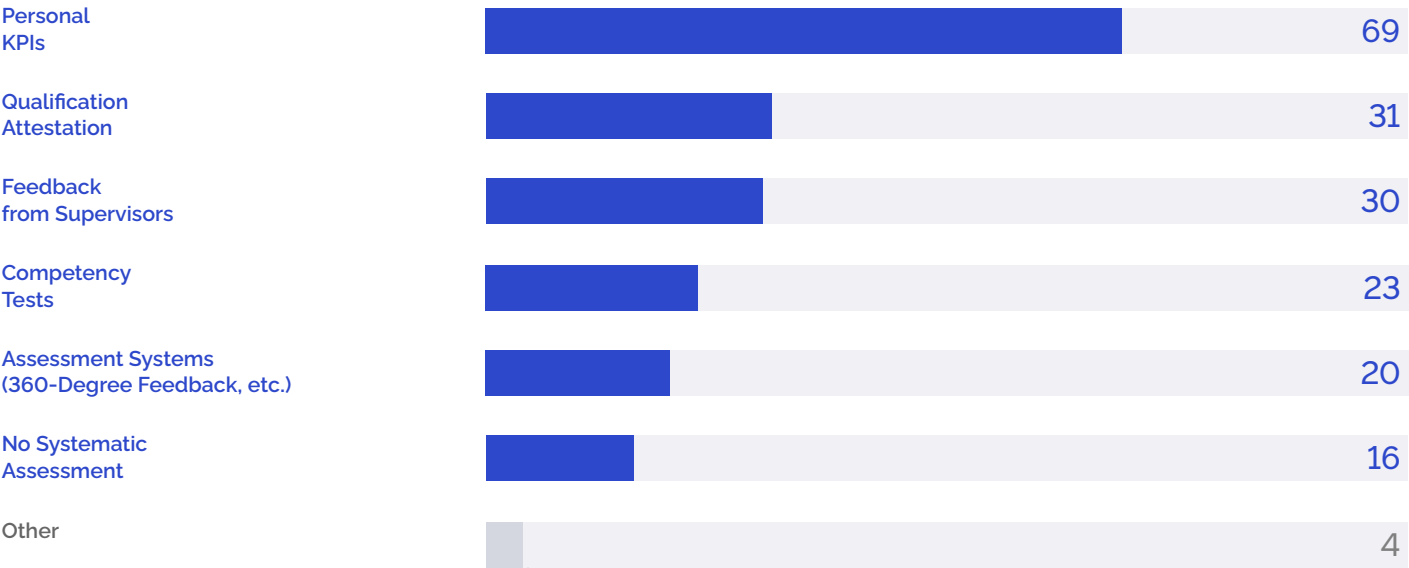
руководитель, консалтинг

Business priorities in relation to employees can be divided into two categories. The first is associated with companies' efforts to increase employee efficiency (75 %), training and unlocking their potential (71 %). The second — steps associated with motivation and engagement of employees (57 %), forming talent pool (57 %), attracting and retaining talents (56 %). In the top-3 priority areas for business, regardless of scale, is increasing maximum output from each team member — including via lean-manufacturing tools.



Employee Qualification Assessment System

%



- Integration of Group and Individual KPIs
- SHL Assessment System
- Annual Individual Review
- Internal Employee Training and Development Programme
- Qualification Assessment Centre — a system for evaluating employees' theoretical and practical knowledge

Respondents talk about developing and implementing internal employee-training programmes as an ongoing task and a key instrument of increasing staff efficiency. All agree that long-term company growth depends to a large extent on this. Systems of employee-qualification evaluation are usually based on personal KPIs (69 %), qualification attestations (31 %) and feedback from supervisors (30 %). There is a demand for additional tools to assess employees and their contribution to team- and company-level results.





Leadership Appointment Strategy

%

Internal Appointments /
Growing Leaders Internally

96

Hiring Externally /
From the Market

36

Inviting Leaders
from Other Countries (Expats)

22

Other

2

- Hire externally, including expats, due to the absence of required profiles in the local market
- Employee experience and skills are analysed and assessed through interviews
- Talent shortages and rapid market growth require a combination of internal development and targeted external hiring

From interviews with the research participants

«Attracting expats becomes harder every year. First, European specialists are not always ready for a full relocation with families. Second, it is quite expensive. They have to be brought in, pay taxes in both countries, social benefits, apartments, schools for children etc. Overall, in our company as in many others, the mid-term goal is to grow local personnel who will be able to replace those expats step by step. If the hired specialist has a three-year contract, our task is — within three years to prepare his successor».

— Head from the processing
& energy field



The study revealed an interesting factor related to strategy for hiring managers. Most companies strive to develop managers internally — almost all participants in the study (96 %) responded this way. They explain this by loyalty of employees to their company, presence of specific knowledge and competencies linked to the particular enterprise, and a desire to avoid long and complex integration of an external person.

Experts opinion



Marina Karban

Vice-Rector for Educational Programmes, Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO

The research confirms that human resource development is becoming a strategic priority for Uzbekistan. More and more companies regard leadership and learning as the basis of long-term growth and sustainability. Business grows and develops together with its employees.

The special importance today is the succession — forming leaders who can not only manage effectively but also share knowledge, develop teams and culture of mentoring. This is exactly what creates a strong foundation for the country's future managerial development.

It is important to note the growing role of female leadership. More and more women in Uzbekistan take on management and entrepreneurial positions, display high motivation, responsibility and readiness for development. Women's participation in management of companies and other economic and social institutions strengthens a culture of trust, empathy and strategic outlook — qualities that are increasingly in demand in modern Uzbekistan and form the basis for sustainable new-generation leadership.



Elena Vitchak

Professor of Business Practice, Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO

Personnel agenda of business in Uzbekistan is in transition — from tactical decisions to systemic human resource management. It is strongly influenced by the high pace of modernization: business in Uzbekistan is becoming more and more digital and will soon become a magnet for talents from many countries.

Creating an environment where employees grow, show initiative and engagement becomes a priority. The HR function is turning from an administrative unit into a strategic business partner. Companies start to recognise the value of motivation, emotional resilience and people's care as an efficiency factor.

By 2027 one can expect a transition from "personnel management" to a mature model of human resource management — based on data, leadership and development of people as the key resource of future growth.



3

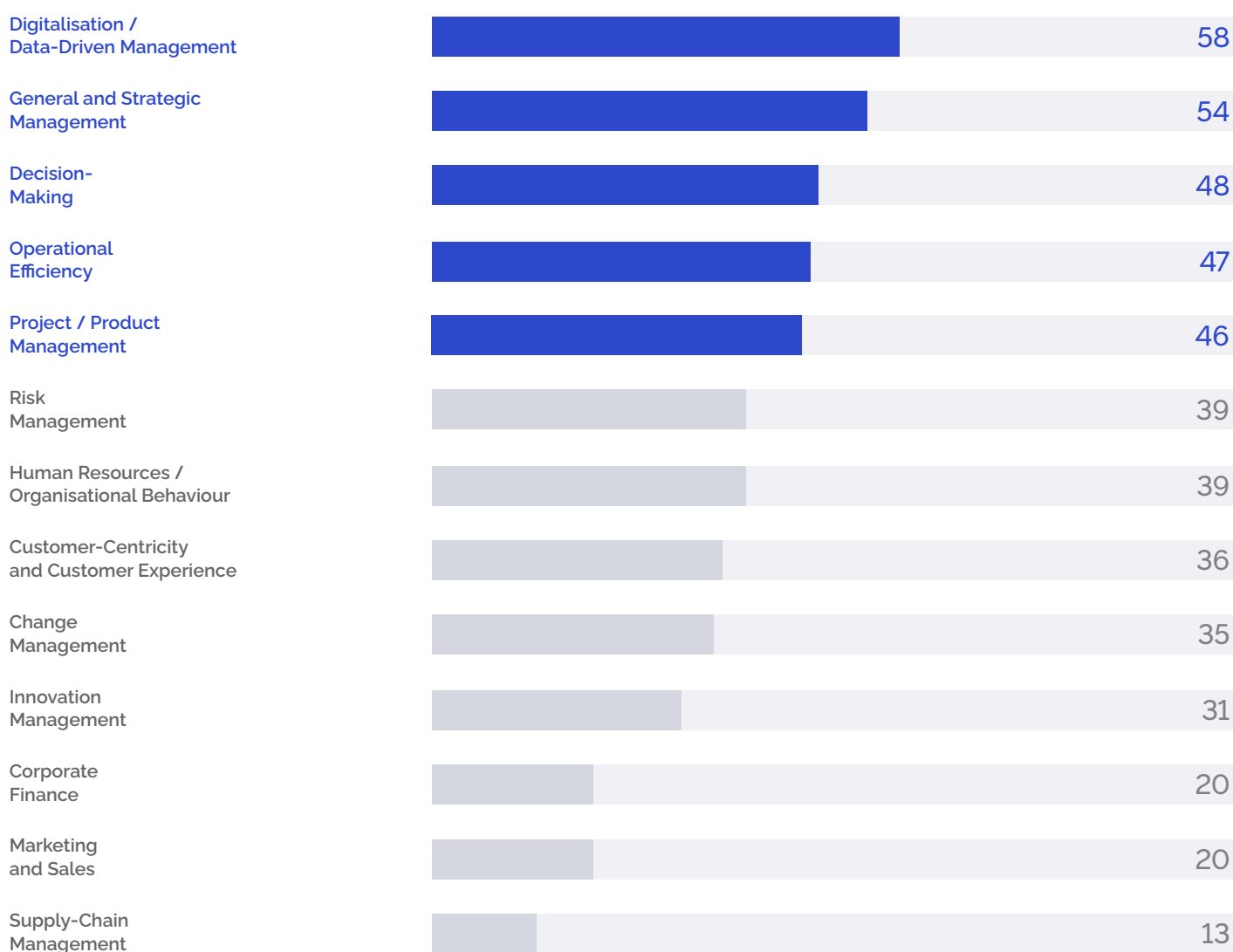
Unite in the Face of a Tide of Data: In-Demand Competencies of Employees





Key Managerial Skills

%

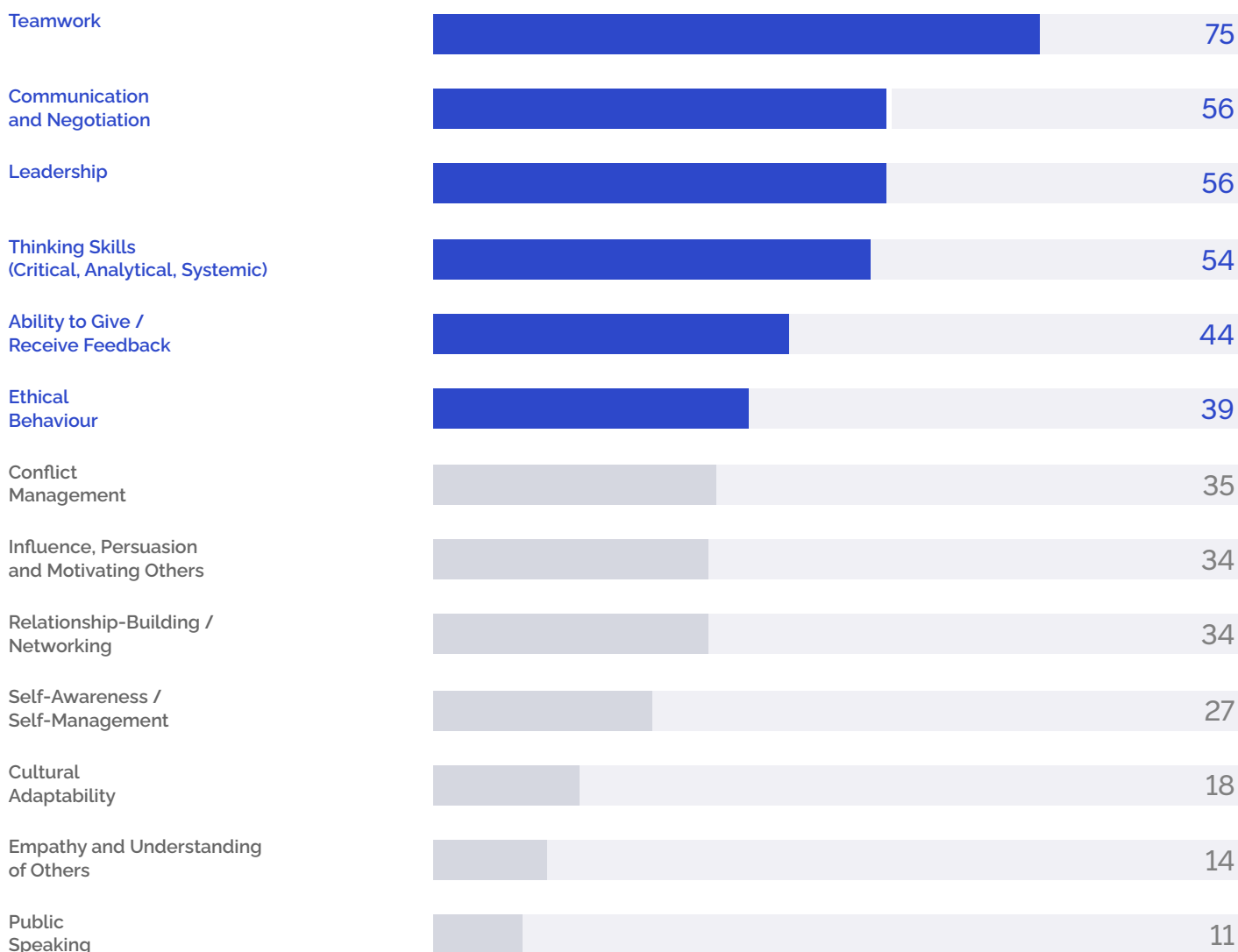


In the top-5 priority management skills for employees are included: digitalisation and data-driven management (58 %), general and strategic management (54 %), decision-making (48 %), operational efficiency (47 %) and project- and product-management (46 %). Such a set of business skills is determined primarily by the increasing volume of information that must be taken into account in decision-making.

It is noteworthy that for companies with fewer than 1 000 employees the priority for operational-efficiency skills is noticeably higher (54 % of respondents) than for larger enterprises (36 %).

Key Soft Skills

%



«There are always certain problems with teamwork and ability to give and receive feedback. This is linked with cultural peculiarities, when negative feedback is not accepted. When you try to highlight some problems for process improvement, then it can be taken "in bad faith". Corporate culture here assumes always very diplomatic, soft, positive relations. It is harder for me to give a feedback to colleagues — at least, harder than when I worked in Russia or Kazakhstan».

— Head from the consulting sphere

In the top-5 "soft" skills for employees are included: teamwork (75 %), communication and negotiations (56 %), leadership (56 %), thinking (54 %) and the ability to give and receive feedback (44 %).

The high demand for teamwork is due to the scale and complexity of tasks and challenges facing companies in Uzbekistan. They require synergy, coordinated and effective work. Moreover, teams are often international, their members need understanding of each other's peculiarities. This factor also affects the culturally-sensitive skill of giving and receiving feedback.

Future Competencies in Demand

%



From interviews with
the research participants

«If we take digital and technological literacy, then our company pays special attention to this direction. We work with the AI topic, plus we have our internal developments related to automation of all processes. We want all our core processes to become automated, and we impose requirements on employees accordingly. Creativity and innovative approach are welcomed. We define ourselves as a young IT-company where ideas not only arise, but also are actively implemented. Therefore, we devote special attention to training and development of employees, and try to do this ourselves — without involving external providers».

— Head from the IT field

Among the competencies of the future respondents pointed out: digital (79 %) and technological (68 %) literacy. Almost equally high attention is paid to creativity and innovation (67 %), thinking (64 %), self-learning and development (61 %).

An interesting fact: critical thinking is mentioned in comparison to over-reliance on artificial intelligence, but does not deny the need to apply and develop it.



Experts opinion



Svetlana Mironyuk

Professor of Business Practice,
Vice-Rector for Operations
and Digital Development, Moscow
School of Management SKOLKOVO

The priority of digitalisation or data-driven management as a primary skill of employees is determined not by fashion, but by rationality. The volume of data that business works with has grown absolutely explosively in the last five years. The quality of management decisions is now determined not by intuition but by how well the team knows how to work with information and trusts it.

Today about two-thirds of companies in the world begin to use AI regularly in at least one business process. This is a new challenge for managers, which means that today you need not only to use data but to be able to set tasks, check the quality of proposed solutions and observe the ethical norms when working with artificial intelligence.

In order for a digital mindset to become part of company culture and its real practice and not a showcase of technologies, it must be locked as a management discipline. Decisions must be based on verifiable data with understanding of their sources; metrics — respond to the company's goals and strategy; access to data must be regulated based on transparent distribution of roles and processes. Employees must not only regularly train on new approaches and tools, but also be motivated to implement new technologies in their teams.

In other words, digitalisation is not the introduction of tools, but a new mentality and culture of decision-making: transparency, responsibility, conformity to rules, ethics and systematic learning.



4

Business Teaches Business: Demand for a Leadership Education



Assessment of Competency Sufficiency

Leadership Competencies	7.69
Hard Skills Professional Knowledge within Area of Responsibility	7.62
Soft Skills Interpersonal and Communication Skills	7.32
Personal Skills Personal Effectiveness	7.44
Understanding of Business Context and Strategic Goals	7.54

Respondents rated the sufficiency of competencies for solving current business tasks on a ten-point scale. Five main competencies received similar results (7+ points), including leadership skills — 7.69 points, "soft" skills — 7.32. Here no surprises: business first of all needs leaders, and leaders need results.

Training of managers in half of the cases happens on-the-job (50 %), in universities and business schools (46 %) of Uzbekistan, inside the company or in a corporate university (45 %). Less often — in a training company (39 %), on an online-university platform or online-courses (35 %), in international business schools (30 %) and in consulting-company courses (29 %).

Companies with more than 1 000 employees more often train their personnel on-the-job (59 %), while smaller enterprises prefer training inside the company or at a corporate university / company training centre (52 %), in universities or business schools of Uzbekistan (51 %).

From interviews with the research participants

«The country needs to develop corporate culture and raise competent leaders who will perform on the same level as international experts. It is necessary to bring in companies which will open perspectives to their local specialists and managers not only in Uzbekistan, but also in the region. We always say that in the company that operates in 40 countries of the world, prospects have no borders. Motivation for an international career can have a great significance».

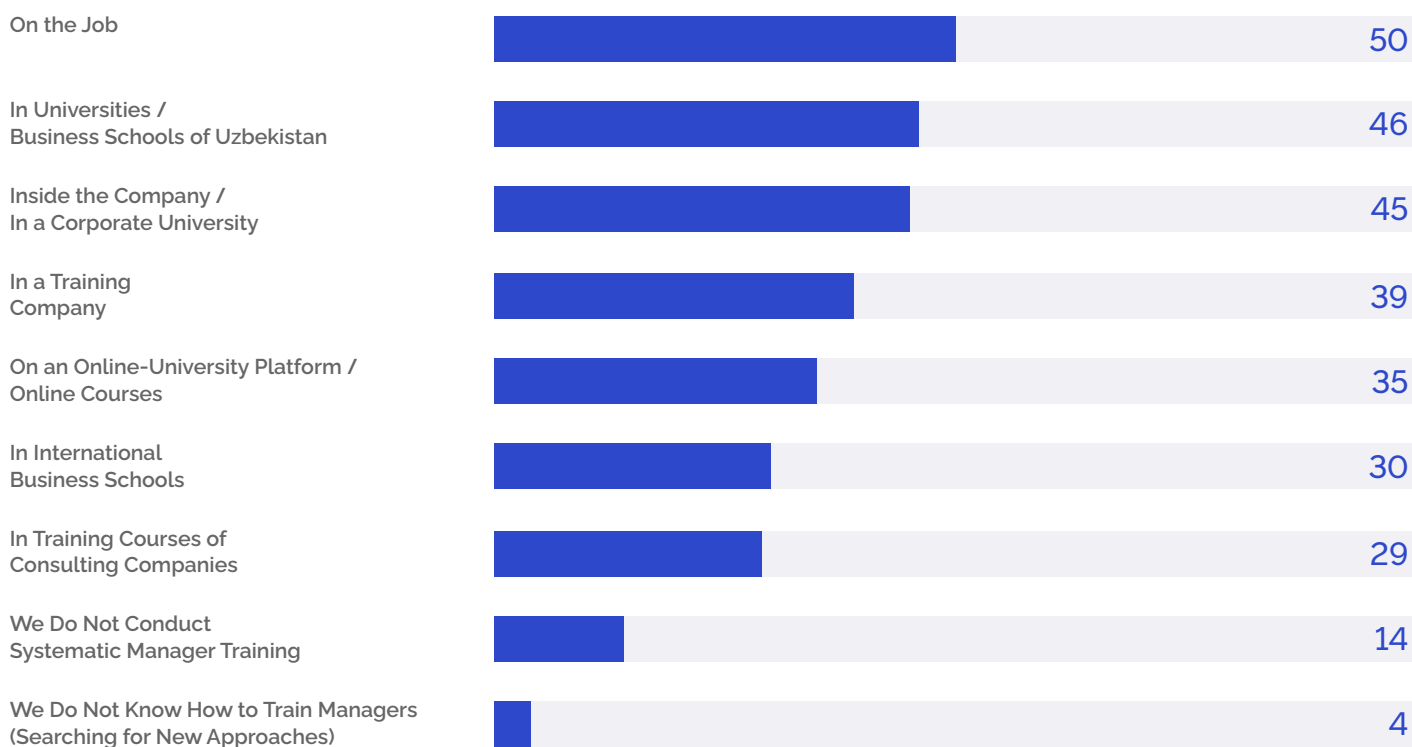
— Head from the processing
& energy sphere





Primary Learning Channels for Managers

%

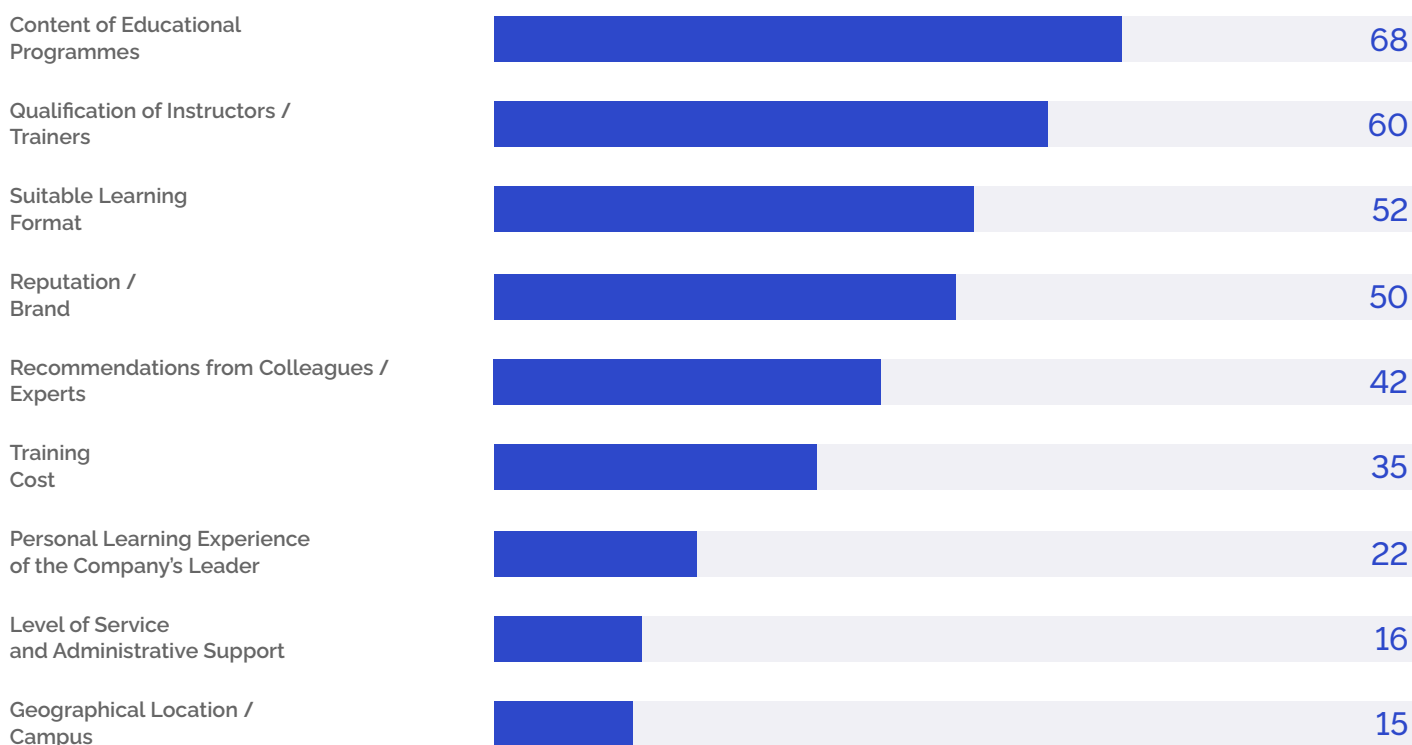


Business teaches business: there is a clear trend for heads of structural units to act as experts for their employees. In comments respondents mentioned corporate learning centres as formalised structures weakly developed or absent in companies.

Only 14 % of companies do not carry out systematic training of managers, and 4 % do not know how to teach them. Most companies widely use internal institutions for training and staff development — if not de jure (as separate structural units), then de facto.

Educational Partner Selection Criteria

%

From interviews with
the research participants

«In my view, universities in Uzbekistan should engage more actively with employers to update their educational programmes. We currently observe a gap between what is taught and what business expects.

Other recommendation is to place greater focus on the new generation, which can be quite challenging to work with.

For companies and employers, I would recommend involving experts and trainers who can teach different generations to communicate effectively — leading to mutual understanding and the building of productive working relationships».

— Head from the consulting sphere

When choosing an educational partner business focuses first of all on educational-programme content (68 %) and qualification of instructors (60 %), pays attention to suitable learning format (52 %), reputation and brand (50 %), guided by opinions of colleagues, experts (42 %) and training cost (35 %). Participants of the research spoke about training cost (per employee and skill set) as a sensitive factor for companies.



Experts opinion



Elizaveta Sadova

Honorary Professor,
Moscow School
of Management SKOLKOVO

The priority management skills indicated by participants in the research reflect the maturity of business in Uzbekistan and its focus on managed growth. Companies are increasingly aware of the need to shift to systemic management based on data, strategy and understanding of the human factor.

First of all, the high demand for digitalisation and data-driven management demonstrates the awareness: the leader of the future must not simply master technological tools but be able to build management decisions using analytics and digital thinking. Alongside this, operational efficiency, project and product management, strategic management form a solid foundation of manageability and business resilience.

However today the key becomes not only development of "hard" managerial competencies, but the ability of leaders to integrate them with the "human dimension" — with understanding of organisational context, culture, values and behaviour patterns specific to Uzbekistan.

In this context, the concept of glocalisation — marrying the global outlook and local understanding — gains growing significance. The need to keep up with the times requires managers to think strategically in the context of global development trends while preserving and developing national identity, mental and cultural features.

This is the task for a new generation of leaders who will lead the country into the future: leaders capable of using best global management practices, adapting them to local conditions. Ultimately Uzbekistan is building its own model of leadership based on the synthesis of global management standards and local values. And this will enable business not to copy foreign formats but to set its own development reference points, sustainably integrating them into management practice and education.

Experts opinion



Evgeny Terukov

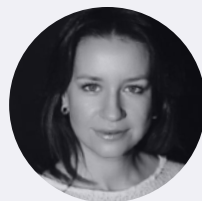
Visiting Professor of Business
Practice, Moscow School
of Management SKOLKOVO

In the Republic of Uzbekistan there remains a significant gap between the needs of companies and the level of preparation of local management personnel both compared with international education standards and with neighbouring countries (for example, Kazakhstan). Due to acute shortage of experienced personnel and rapidly rising salary expectations companies will need to actively invest in development of their own managers and reserves with potential.

In my view this requires creation of two types of programmes:

- Short "strategic-focus programmes" for top leaders, gathered around strategic initiatives: digitalisation and digital transformation, operational efficiency
- "Ahead-of-time development" programmes — accelerators of efficiency for management talent pool with "hard-skills" (data-driven decision-making, general management, operational efficiency, project-management) and "soft-skills" (teamwork, communication and negotiation, critical thinking) tracked.

Companies that first form a pool of such programmes will obtain necessary competitive advantage to realise the high growth potential embedded in the country's economy.



Anna Semenova

Director of Corporate Clients
Development, Moscow School
of Management SKOLKOVO

Data of the study show that the management-education market in Uzbekistan is entering a phase of qualitative change.

Managers today mostly learn inside companies, on the job, and in local universities, which indicates a growing demand for practice-oriented learning embedded in daily activity. However, at the same time a lack of systemic corporate universities and partnerships with external business schools is noticeable. This creates space for integration of international educational standards into the national ecosystem of leadership development.

It is also important that learning is more and more perceived as a strategic investment rather than a cost. Companies in Uzbekistan are ready to invest in development of management competencies if they see a direct link with growth of efficiency and business results.

For us as a business school this is a signal: it is necessary to build long-term partnerships, helping companies to build their own systems of learning and career development, combining best international practices with local context. Herein lies the potential of sustainable and mutually beneficial growth.

Conclusions & recommendations

Business in Uzbekistan is in a phase of active growth and development. For companies, the most in-demand management competencies are those related to digitalisation, strategic thinking, effective communication and leadership. That is — all competencies that ensure sustainable development in conditions of growing market competition.

At the same time the need is growing for a new-type manager able to combine technological, analytical and humanistic skills, operate in a multicultural environment and adapt quickly to change. The results of this study reflect the aggregated position of leading market players regarding management competencies and personnel priorities in the Republic of Uzbekistan.

The development of these competencies requires systemic work by the state, business and educational institutions — creating a unified environment where a person learns throughout their career.

Based on the results of the research Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO recommends to consider a suite of initiatives aimed at shaping and developing a modern national system for management-competency development. These measures are based on the analysis of business needs in Uzbekistan, best international practices and successful examples of implementation of similar systems in fast-growing economies.

1

Creation of a national model of management and professional competencies

The study showed that the key skills of the future necessary for business development in Uzbekistan are: digital literacy, data analytics, strategic thinking, decision-making and change-management. A unified model will allow to set a single coordinate system and long-term priorities for business, will help link corporate programmes, university courses and state initiatives into a unified system of management-competency development.

We propose developing and adopting a unified national model of management competencies, that reflects current business requirements across all management levels — from frontline supervisors to top executives. This study can serve as a foundational step and methodological framework for building such a national model.

The next step could be broadening the focus of the study to professional, including technological competencies, in demand by business in the medium- and long-term perspective. This will allow transition from a model of management competencies to a forward-looking model of professional competencies for the development of economy and business in the Republic of Uzbekistan.

Implementing the national competency model implies analysing the educational potential and availability of educational programmes on prospective competencies in Uzbekistan's universities. This will allow launching a mechanism of long-term balancing of supply and demand for forward-looking competencies for national-economy development.

2

Development of the top 10 future competencies (Hard & Soft Skills)

The research showed that business success depends directly on a combination of management (hard) and social (soft) competencies. Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO recommends implementing a comprehensive support system for developing the top 10 future competencies.

HARD SKILLS —

управленческие компетенции:

- 1 **Digital competencies & AI**
mandatory modules on digital management, artificial intelligence and automation in all advanced-training programmes.
- 2 **Data-Driven Management**
development of culture of decision-making based on analytics and metrics.
- 3 **Strategic thinking & decision-making**
goal-setting, vision and mission development, scenario planning, business-analysis and managerial-decision-making approaches.
- 4 **Operational efficiency**
modern practices of organising effective processes, lean manufacturing, financial literacy.
- 5 **Project management**
introduction of agile-management tools and certification of managers by international standards.

SOFT SKILLS —

личностные и социальные компетенции:

- 1 **Leadership and team management**
development of culture of management and responsibility.
- 2 **Emotional intelligence and self-regulation**
forming conscious leadership and resilience to stress.
- 3 **Communication and negotiation**
development of public-speaking skills, feedback and cross-cultural interaction.
- 4 **Creativity and innovative thinking**
introduction of design-thinking methodologies and support for collaboration between business and science.
- 5 **Self-learning and lifelong development**
promoting the culture as a national idea of continuous learning.

We recommend to form open educational courses on the specified competencies, available to a wide circle of today's and future employees of companies in Uzbekistan — from students and interns to high-level executives. Such courses will contribute to rapid increase in management literacy and business-effectiveness. This initiative can be realised with participation of state, business and educational institutions of the country.



3

Formation of a network of national leaders in business education, including business schools and corporate universities

Rapid economic-growth speeds require not only continued competency development of company employees, but also forming new management knowledge based on best management practices of companies in Uzbekistan. Such a function is often fulfilled in fast-growing economies by business schools and corporate universities, which bring together talented teams of instructors and researchers working to international standards. This allows not only describing new management practices and tools, but also rapidly creating educational programmes needed by business.

We recommend to accelerate development of a network of leading business-education organisations — national business schools and corporate universities established both from scratch and based on existing universities and company training centres in Uzbekistan. This will allow ensuring systemic and sustainable reproduction and development of the country's management capital, as well as forming centres of sectoral expertise for dissemination of best management practices and increasing business competitiveness.

4

Creation of a talent-pool development and succession programme

The study showed that forming a talent pool and developing succession are among the key priorities of Uzbek companies in the coming years. More than half of the organisations surveyed mark this as one of the central tasks in the field of human-personnel management.

Today most companies adhere to internal appointment strategy (96 %), explaining this by high loyalty of employees and knowledge of the corporate context. However approaches to preparation of future leaders are often situational: there are no formalised assessment procedures, career-tracks and development-support mechanisms. For government bodies and large enterprises succession becomes a strategic factor of sustainability — a guarantee of maintaining management competence and competitiveness.

We recommend to create a unified, transparent and long-term system of forming talent pool for business and public administration, that would ensure continuity of leadership, growth of professional managers and development of internal management potential of the country. .

A unified career-development system "Talent Pool & Succession: the Future Business Leaders of Uzbekistan" will allow creation of an end-to-end trajectory "school — university — company", as well as develop effective tools for assessing potential and performance of employees with a system of career-development recommendations..



5

Annual research into management competencies

Moscow School of Management SKOLKOVO **recommends to institutionalise the annual conduct of the national-level research of management competencies and survey of top companies** as a permanent element of the country's human-capital-development system.

Business landscape in Uzbekistan is developing at unprecedented speed. The country has become one of the region's growth-leaders in terms of economic growth and digital transformation. Expansion of the domestic market, arrival of international investors and national companies' entry into external markets form a new circle of managerial challenges. In these conditions the need for reliable data on leaders' priorities and competencies becomes strategically important.



EXED SKOLKOVO
School of Management

**Olga
Markova**
Head of Corporate Client
Development Central Asia

+7 916 443 73 03
olga_markova@skolkovo.ru

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